

AI Workshop Competitive and Strategic Intelligence Brief

Approach and caveats

This briefing triangulates **company annual reports / investor materials**, **official newsroom releases**, and **credible third-party reporting** to map (a) each firm's **stated strategy and KPIs**, (b) **value chain pain points**, and (c) **AI/GenAI opportunities** that best align to near-term execution realities. Where firms are **private** (Air India; ALDI), financial and KPI visibility is inherently constrained; those gaps are explicitly flagged and should be validated directly in the workshop. Air India financials are referenced from Tata Sons' annual reporting; ALDI global financials are largely third-party estimates due to limited consolidated public reporting. ¹

ABN AMRO

Section 1: Company snapshot

ABN AMRO is a major Dutch bank with an operating model organized around three core client businesses: **Personal & Business Banking**, **Corporate Banking**, and **Wealth Management**, each with distinct client sets and product economics (e.g., mortgages and retail banking, lending and capital solutions for corporates, and private banking/investing products). ²

In its **2024 integrated annual reporting**, ABN AMRO frames its strategy around three themes: **"a personal bank in the digital age"** (customer experience), **"distinctive expertise in sustainability transitions,"** and **"building a future-proof bank."** ³

From the most recent publicly referenced annual reporting for FY2024, ABN AMRO reported **net profit of €2,403 million**, **ROE of 10.1%**, a **cost/income ratio of 61.7%**, and **CET1 ratio of 14.0%** (Basel III), highlighting profitability but also a cost base that management and external analysts characterize as needing further structural improvement. ⁴

Leadership and strategic direction shifted meaningfully in 2025. In its annual reporting narrative, ABN AMRO references leadership transition planning, and by late 2025 its strategy reset is explicitly associated with CEO **Marguerite Bérard** and a **2026–2028 roadmap** focused on profitable growth and cost rightsizing. ⁵

At its **Capital Markets Day (strategy for 2026–2028)**, ABN AMRO set three strategic priorities: **accelerate profitable growth**, **right-size the cost base (net reduction of 5,200 FTEs by 2028 vs. 2024)**, and **deploy capital toward higher returns**. ⁶

The same 2028 plan is disciplined by explicit KPI targets (to be treated as workshop “north star” constraints): **income above €10bn, ROE ≥12%, cost/income <~55%, and CET1 >13.75%**. ⁷

Section 2: Customer profile and stakeholder landscape

ABN AMRO’s primary customer landscape spans: (a) **retail and small business** customers (payments, deposits, mortgages, SME lending), (b) **commercial/corporate** clients (lending, transaction banking, sector expertise), and (c) **wealth/private banking** clients (advice, discretionary mandates, investing). ²

Customer experience and loyalty are explicitly tracked via **Net Promoter Score (NPS)**. ABN AMRO states that **NPS increased across all client units in 2024**, and ties customer progress to tangible service capacity increases (e.g., expansion of “Help with Banking Advisers”) and use of **generative AI to improve customer experience**. ⁸

Competitive pressure in Dutch banking is most acute in “high-volume, low-margin” products such as **new mortgage production**; ABN AMRO highlights that its **market share in new mortgage production increased from 16% to 19%** (a sign that distribution + experience improvements are translating into growth). ⁹

Key stakeholders shaping AI feasibility include Dutch and EU regulators (e.g., data privacy expectations), model risk and audit functions, and supervisory stakeholders who have historically placed strong scrutiny on banks’ **KYC/AML effectiveness** and operational resilience—constraints that directly influence how fast GenAI can be scaled beyond employee copilots into customer-facing decisions. (This is a structural inference grounded in banking governance requirements; validate ABN-specific constraints in workshop.)

Section 3: Value chain analysis

ABN AMRO’s end-to-end value chain, aligned to its segments and strategy themes, concentrates value creation (and friction) in the following stages:

Value chain stage	Activities	Data assets generated/consumed	Typical inefficiencies / pain points to probe in workshop
Origination and onboarding	Digital + assisted onboarding, account opening, product cross-sell	Customer identity, device and channel telemetry, application documents	Friction and rework when document quality is poor; handoffs between digital and human channels
Underwriting and credit decisioning	Mortgage/SME/corporate credit assessment, pricing, covenanting	Financial statements, bureau data, transaction data, collateral valuations	Manual spreading and narrative assessment; inconsistent risk appetite translation into decisions
Compliance and KYC/AML	KYC refresh, screening, transaction monitoring, SAR workflows	KYC profiles, screening hits, transaction graphs	High false positives, analyst workload, fragmented case notes; auditability requirements

Value chain stage	Activities	Data assets generated/consumed	Typical inefficiencies / pain points to probe in workshop
Risk management	Portfolio monitoring, stress tests, early warning	Loan book + macro variables, scenario libraries	Slow refresh cycles; explainability constraints; siloed risk signals
Customer servicing	Contact center, secure messaging, complaints handling	Interaction logs, knowledge base content	Long tail of “complex but common” queries; knowledge drift; inconsistent resolution quality
Wealth management	Suitability, portfolio construction, reporting	Client objectives, market data, research	Advisor time spent on summarization/report drafting vs. advice
Back office operations	Payments ops, reconciliations, collections, finance	Transaction ledgers, exception queues	Manual exception handling; data lineage ambiguity obstructing automation

This mapping should be treated as a **hypothesis scaffold**; ABN AMRO’s cost-base right-sizing target strongly implies a need to remove human-intensive work across KYC, servicing, and back office without raising operational risk. ⁶

Section 4: AI and technology investment landscape

ABN AMRO’s public AI footprint shows a pragmatic pattern: (a) **customer-facing conversational AI**, (b) **employee productivity tooling**, and (c) operational analytics.

- ABN AMRO is publicly referenced as using **Microsoft Copilot Studio** to build internal and external chatbots (e.g., “Anna” and “Abby”) intended to improve self-service and reduce operational load. ¹⁰
- ABN AMRO has also been referenced in IBM materials for conversational AI in customer service (“Anna”), indicating multi-vendor conversational capabilities. ¹¹
- The bank’s own reflections on 2024 performance explicitly connect customer support improvements with **generative AI use for customer experience**. ⁹
- ABN AMRO has been associated with **process mining** maturation via a dedicated **Process Mining Center of Excellence**, suggesting a data-driven approach to pinpointing automation opportunities. ¹²
- Organization and operating model: ABN AMRO publicly describes a sizable **Data & Analytics department** spanning data science, data engineering, and governance/enablement elements—useful context for feasibility of scaled AI delivery (though exact scale is not consistently disclosed in public sources). ¹³

Technology/AI spend: ABN AMRO does not consistently disclose a clean “AI spend” line item in easily accessible public reporting; workshop validation should clarify (1) run vs change IT budget, (2) data platform spend, and (3) GenAI experimentation budget by domain.

Responsible AI / governance: Public sources in this dataset emphasize AI deployment, but ABN-specific Responsible AI framework details are not consolidated here; treat as a **data gap** to validate (especially given EU banking governance expectations).

Section 5: Broader strategic challenges

ABN AMRO's disclosed strategy reset implies the following top challenges (ranked by structural importance to the 2028 KPI set):

- 1) **Structural cost competitiveness gap:** The 2028 plan explicitly targets cost/income <~55% and includes a net **5,200 FTE reduction** by 2028 vs 2024—indicating the cost base is strategically constraining returns. ¹⁴
- 2) **Legacy complexity and tech modernization burden:** ABN AMRO's strategy narrative and external reporting tie the turnaround to simplifying operations and phasing out legacy systems as part of digitalization, a common drag on change velocity and AI scaling. ¹⁵
- 3) **Capital allocation pressure:** The plan emphasizes deploying capital where it generates highest returns, implying continued scrutiny on business mix (e.g., mortgage growth, wealth focus, corporate RWAs). ¹⁶
- 4) **Growth in mortgages amid competition:** ABN AMRO highlights mortgage share movement (16%→19% in new production) and intends to accelerate profitable growth—mortgages offer scale but require operational excellence to defend margin. ¹⁷
- 5) **KYC/AML and operational risk:** While not quantified here, ABN's emphasis on a future-proof bank and deployment of AI into CX implies a need to raise automation while preserving auditability; validate operational risk bottlenecks directly. ¹⁸

Section 6: AI opportunity mapping

The table below proposes AI opportunities that align directly to ABN AMRO's stated 2026–2028 priorities (profit growth + cost right-sizing + capital efficiency). Impact and effort are rated qualitatively for workshop prioritization.

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis tied to strategy	Feasibility	Key barriers	Impact vs effort
GenAI KYC “case co-pilot” (document summarization, checklist completion, rationale drafting)	KYC / onboarding / compliance	GenAI + retrieval (RAG) + workflow automation	Reduces analyst time and improves consistency—supports FTE reduction goals without compromising controls. ¹⁹	Medium-High (banks hold structured KYC + unstructured docs)	Model risk governance; data leakage controls; audit trail	High / Medium

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis tied to strategy	Feasibility	Key barriers	Impact vs effort
Next-best action & churn prevention for mortgages and retail products	Origination + servicing	Predictive + uplift modeling; experimentation	Defends and grows profitable retail share (mortgages); ABN already emphasizes increased mortgage share. ¹⁷	Medium	Channel integration; consent/privacy; attribution	High / Medium
AML alert triage optimization (reduce false positives)	Compliance & risk	Graph ML + anomaly detection + prioritization	Improves risk effectiveness and reduces operational load; aligns to future-proof bank theme. ²⁰	Medium	Regulatory expectations; explainability; data quality	High / High
Contact center “resolution copilot” (agent assist + knowledge grounding)	Customer service	GenAI RAG; speech analytics	Better CX and lower handling time; ABN explicitly links GenAI to CX improvement. ²¹	High	Knowledge base quality; safe responses; handoff design	High / Medium
Process mining → automation factory (target the 2028 cost/income goal)	Back office	Process mining + task mining + RPA/IPA	Industrializes discovery-to-automation pipeline; ABN has a Process Mining CoE signal. ²²	High	Change management; standardization across units	High / Medium

Section 7: Peer and competitor AI benchmarking

ABN AMRO's Dutch peer set is typically **ING** and **Rabobank** (and broader European banks in corporate/wealth niches). As an illustrative benchmark, ING has publicly described building and launching a **customer-facing generative AI chatbot** with QuantumBlack, emphasizing customer experience leadership and responsible scaling—highlighting how peers are positioning GenAI as a differentiator in service and operations. ²³

AI leadership in European banking, based on observable disclosures, generally includes: enterprise-wide governance, safe GenAI copilots, and targeted high-ROI workflows (KYC, servicing, underwriting) rather than end-to-end “autonomous banking” (validate ABN’s appetite). ²⁴

Section 8: Workshop-ready insight summary

Company narrative: ABN AMRO is repositioning from “strategy foundation” to a **2026–2028 execution plan** that explicitly targets **higher returns and materially lower cost intensity**, with growth focused where it can win (notably mortgages and wealth) and with technology modernization and efficiency at the core. ¹⁴

Top value chain pain points most amenable to AI: compliance/KYC operational load, contact center + servicing productivity, and back-office exception handling (especially where process mining can identify repeatable waste). ²⁵

Top AI opportunities with best strategic fit: GenAI KYC co-pilot; agent/service copilot with grounded knowledge; process mining → automation factory. ²⁶

Key questions for ABN leadership:

How will ABN operationalize the 5,200 FTE net reduction—through process redesign, automation, sourcing, or a mix? ²⁷

Which processes are the “cost/income killers” today (e.g., KYC, collections, complaints) and what is the measurable baseline (AHT, rework, backlog)?

What is ABN’s model risk standard for GenAI (audit trails, human approval thresholds) and what is the fastest path to “safe scale”?

Bold AI bet: A “**RegOps Digital Twin**”: unify KYC/AML workflows, process mining insights, and GenAI case copilots into a single control-grade operating layer that continuously reduces false positives and cycle time while producing audit-ready rationale—turning compliance from a cost center into a scalable capability aligned to the 2028 cost and ROE targets. ²⁸

Vodafone

Section 1: Company snapshot

Vodafone positions itself as a leading European and African telecommunications operator, structured across **Vodafone Business, Europe Consumer, and Africa Consumer**, supported by shared operations and infrastructure assets; it sells primarily **fixed and mobile connectivity**, but also pursues growth in **digital services, IoT, and financial services**. ²⁹

Scale and footprint: Vodafone reports serving **over 275 million customers in 15 countries**, with **over 51 million FinTech users**, plus additional customers through joint ventures/associates and partner markets. ²⁹

Headline FY25 metrics (year ended 31 March 2025): **total revenue €37.4bn**, **service revenue €30.8bn**, and **Adjusted EBITDAaL €10.9bn**; Vodafone also disclosed an **operating loss of €0.4bn** driven by **€4.5bn non-cash impairments in Germany and Romania**. ³⁰

Strategic priorities (explicit): Vodafone’s CEO describes a roadmap built around **Customers, Simplicity, and Growth**, tracked via an operational scorecard including NPS leadership (leading/co-leading in 9/15 markets) and transformation productivity. ³¹

Leadership: Vodafone’s Executive Committee is chaired by CEO **Margherita Della Valle**, with roles including **Group CTO Scott Petty**, **Group CNO Alberto Ripepi**, and **Group CFO Pilar López** (appointed effective 1 Oct 2025 as CFO designate to succeed Luka Mucic). ³²

Section 2: Customer profile and stakeholder landscape

Customer segments span mass-market **consumer/mobile & fixed, enterprise and public sector (Vodafone Business)**, and **FinTech users** (notably in Africa). Vodafone sells and supports customers in both **digital and physical channels**. ²⁹

Customer journey touchpoints include: digital onboarding and account management (e.g., apps/web), network experience across access technologies, billing, and customer care (call centers/retail), with growing emphasis on self-service and AI augmentation. ³³

Customer satisfaction: Vodafone reports improvements in customer experience and claims **leading or co-leading net promoter scores in 9 of 15 markets**, with notable improvements in the UK and Germany. ³¹

Vodafone’s report pages reference NPS as a KPI but do not consistently expose a single global NPS value in extractable text; treat absolute NPS as a **data gap** to confirm during the workshop. ³⁴

Competitive pressure: Vodafone explicitly frames its need to improve customer experience while simplifying operations and growing digital services (now ~10% of Group service revenue), implying competition not only from telcos but also from digital-first service expectations. ³⁵

Section 3: Value chain analysis

Vodafone’s telco value chain is dominated by capital-intensive network activity and high-volume customer operations.

Value chain stage	Activities	Data assets generated/consumed	Typical inefficiencies / pain points to probe
Network planning & build	Radio/fiber/cable rollout; capacity planning	Network telemetry; GIS; demand forecasts	Over/under-build risk; long planning cycles; cross-domain coordination
Network operations	Fault detection, performance monitoring, incident response	Real-time performance metrics; alarms; trouble tickets	“Alarm floods,” slow root cause analysis, repeat incidents
Customer acquisition & onboarding	Marketing, identity verification, order management	Campaign data; KYC; channel data	High drop-off in digital funnels; friction between digital and retail

Value chain stage	Activities	Data assets generated/consumed	Typical inefficiencies / pain points to probe
Billing & revenue assurance	Rating, charging, invoicing, dispute management	CDRs; billing ledgers; partner settlements	Revenue leakage; complex exceptions; dispute volumes
Customer care	Call centers; chat; field support	Conversation logs; CRM; knowledge base	High call volumes, long handling time, inconsistent resolution
IT/BSS/OSS modernization	Platform change, cloud migration	Application logs; service inventories	Technical debt; integration complexity
Roaming/partner management	Inter-operator agreements; settlement	Roaming usage; fraud signals	Fraud exposure; reconciliation complexity

Section 4: AI and technology investment landscape

Vodafone is unusually explicit about its **AI governance** and **GenAI scaling intent**:

- Vodafone states it first released an **ethical AI framework in 2019** and has since formalized governance with an **AI Governance Board** chaired by the **Vodafone CTO** and supported by a **Global AI Data and Analytics function** plus a **Responsible AI Office**; it also implemented **responsible AI guardrails** for generative AI on internal platforms. ³⁶
- Vodafone signed a **10-year strategic partnership with Microsoft** to bring GenAI, digital services, and cloud capabilities to customers across Europe and Africa. ³⁷
- Third-party industry coverage reports Vodafone will invest **\$1.5bn over 10 years** in cloud and customer-focused AI services developed with Microsoft (useful as a spend anchor, though workshop should validate accounting treatment and scope). ³⁸
- Vodafone's leadership communications highlight GenAI initiatives such as "SuperTOBi" and "SuperAgent" to improve customer experience and agent productivity. ³⁹
- Vodafone has collaborated with **Google Cloud** on an ML platform ("AI Booster Platform") built on **Vertex AI** to accelerate global scaling of ML use cases. ⁴⁰
- Vodafone Business announced an **AI-powered service automation** collaboration with **ServiceNow**, targeting reductions in repetitive work and case volume. ⁴¹

Evidence of measured impact: Reporting from a CEO summit attributes to Vodafone that call center call frequency dropped by **~20%** after using generative AI, alongside materially improved customer satisfaction (treat as an external quote; validate baselines and attribution). ⁴²

Section 5: Broader strategic challenges

1) **Germany structural headwinds and impairment risk**: Vodafone disclosed €4.5bn impairment charges (Germany and Romania) and cites German performance issues (including impacts related to regulation such as the MDU TV law change) as a major driver of FY25 operating loss. ³⁰

2) **Complexity and tech/operational simplification**: The strategy explicitly targets simplification via shared operations and large-scale role reductions (7,700 delivered by FY25 vs a 10k plan, restated for disposals). ⁴³

3) **Portfolio reshaping execution risk**: Vodafone highlights disposals (Vodafone Spain and Vodafone Italy as discontinued operations) as part of its reshaping, which creates both focus benefits and integration/

separation complexity. ³⁰

4) **Privacy, cyber, and AI risk management:** Vodafone describes extensive privacy governance (training targets and completion, risk assessments, and oversight committees), and extends risk controls into AI via internal risk assessment and guardrails—indicating ongoing compliance cost and execution burden. ⁴⁴

5) **Sustaining growth while monetizing digital services:** Vodafone reports digital services at ~10% of Group service revenue and seeks further growth, implying pressure to scale platforms without eroding core connectivity economics. ³⁵

Section 6: AI opportunity mapping

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis	Feasibility	Barriers	Impact vs effort
"Self-healing network" incident intelligence	Network ops	Predictive + anomaly detection + LLM-assisted triage	Reduce outages, improve reliability and NPS leadership position; lowers op cost via fewer truck rolls. ⁴⁵	Medium (rich telemetry exists)	Toolchain fragmentation; model drift; accountability	High / High
GenAI customer care at scale (SuperTOBi expansion + agent assist)	Customer care	GenAI + RAG + agent workflows	Reduce call volumes/ handle times; external reporting suggests large effects when GenAI is deployed well. ⁴⁶	High	Hallucination control; multilingual quality; brand risk	High / Medium
Roaming fraud & revenue assurance intelligence	Partner mgmt + billing	Graph ML + anomaly detection	Reduce fraud losses and leakage in complex interconnect ecosystems	Medium	Partner data sharing; false positives	Medium-High / High

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis	Feasibility	Barriers	Impact vs effort
Enterprise “network & security copilot”	Vodafone Business	GenAI + knowledge grounding	Faster resolution and upsell in B2B service ops; complements ServiceNow service automation approach. ⁴⁷	Medium	Productization; security constraints	Medium-High / Medium
Cloud/IT estate optimization with AI	IT/BSS/ OSS	AIOps + FinOps + GenAI ops runbooks	Supports Simplicity + cost takeout (role reductions + opex savings). ⁴³	High	Ownership boundaries; change mgmt	High / Medium

Section 7: Peer and competitor AI benchmarking

Vodafone’s peer landscape includes large European telcos such as **Deutsche Telekom**, **Orange**, and **Telefónica** (market-by-market). As an illustrative benchmark, Deutsche Telekom’s 2024 annual reporting describes an **AI Competence Center (AICC)** created in 2023, adoption of multiple GenAI models, and ethical AI guidelines—representing the kind of institutional AI operating model Vodafone is also building.

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Section 8: Workshop-ready insight summary

Company narrative: Vodafone is mid-transformation: simplifying operations, reshaping the footprint, and using AI—under a formal Responsible AI governance model—to materially improve customer experience and unlock new digital revenue, while navigating structural challenges in Germany. ⁴⁹

Top value chain pain points best suited for AI: network incident complexity, customer care costs/detractors, and revenue assurance in a partner-heavy ecosystem. ⁵⁰

Top AI opportunities: GenAI customer care scale-up; AI-driven self-healing network operations; AI-enabled service automation across Vodafone Business. ⁵¹

Key workshop questions:

Where are Vodafone’s highest-cost “work queues” (network ops vs care vs billing), and what is the current automation coverage? ³¹

What guardrails and approval workflows are required to safely expand GenAI into customer-facing journeys at scale? ⁴⁴

How should Vodafone measure AI value: NPS, detractor reduction, opex savings, or revenue growth from digital services? ⁴³

Bold AI bet: A **cross-domain “Telco Operations Agent”** that unifies network telemetry, OSS/BSS, and customer interaction context to proactively prevent incidents, reroute capacity, and resolve customer-impacting issues before they generate calls—executed under Vodafone’s existing Responsible AI governance and guardrails. ⁵²

Air India

Section 1: Company snapshot

Air India is India’s flag carrier under Tata Group ownership, articulating a multi-year transformation vision to become “a world-class global airline with an Indian heart,” benchmarked against leading global carriers across customer service, technology, product, reliability, and hospitality. ⁵³

Its transformation plan, **Vihaan.AI**, emphasizes five pillars: **exceptional customer experience, robust operations, industry-best talent, industry leadership, and commercial efficiency/profitability.** ⁵³

Leadership: Air India’s CEO & Managing Director is **Campbell Wilson** (appointed by Tata Sons / Air India board). ⁵⁴

Air India also publicly references digital leadership through **Dr. Satya Ramaswamy, Chief Digital & Technology Officer**, particularly in its creation of a dedicated **Centre of Digital Innovation (CODi)** focused on customer-facing digital touchpoints and “cutting-edge data and AI capabilities.” ⁵⁵

Financial snapshot (most recent annual reporting available in this dataset): Tata Sons’ FY25 annual reporting includes a subsidiary summary table for **Air India Limited** showing **Turnover of ₹61,079.74 crore** and **Loss after tax of ₹(3,975.75) crore**, with Tata group ownership reported at **73.82%** (note: interpret as Air India entity reporting presented within Tata Sons’ annual report; validate consolidation/perimeter in workshop given airline mergers). ⁵⁶

Fleet modernization: Air India’s newsroom describes a landmark order of **470 aircraft (Airbus + Boeing)** and an additional **100 Airbus aircraft**, totaling **570 aircraft ordered**, framed as central to Vihaan.AI and modernization of the fleet. ⁵⁷

Section 2: Customer profile and stakeholder landscape

Customer segments span domestic and international travelers across leisure, business, visiting-friends-and-relatives (VFR), and premium long-haul markets. Key customer journey stages include: trip shopping, booking, servicing/refunds, airport operations (check-in, baggage), and in-flight experience. Air India explicitly aims to improve CX “across all key touchpoints—online, on the ground and in the air,” supported by a unified customer data platform and AI-assisted tools for staff. ⁵⁸

Pain points and churn drivers (publicly observable): external reporting notes Air India has been “continually criticised by passengers for poor service and ageing craft,” highlighting that reliability and product quality were structural issues pre-transformation (workshop should quantify: OTP, mishandled baggage, complaints, refund cycle time). ⁵⁹

Stakeholders shaping feasibility: airports and ground handlers, DGCA and other aviation regulators, aircraft OEMs and engine OEMs (delivery constraints), technology vendors (CRM/cloud), and alliance partners (Star Alliance positioning and interline). ⁶⁰

Section 3: Value chain analysis

Value chain stage	Activities	Data assets generated/ consumed	Typical inefficiencies / pain points
Fleet & route planning	Network design, aircraft allocation	Historical demand, aircraft performance	Constraints-driven planning complexity, especially during fleet transition
Revenue management	Fare filing, inventory control, ancillaries	PNR, demand curves, competitor pricing	Forecast errors, inconsistent ancillaries attach, disruption impacts
Airport operations	Check-in, boarding, baggage, turnaround	DCS logs, baggage scans	Queue variability, baggage exceptions, turnaround delays
Crew scheduling	Pairings, legality checks, disruptions	Crew rosters, fatigue rules	Manual re-rostering during IRROPS; high cost of mis-optimization
Customer experience	Service, refunds, re-accommodation	CRM, case history, policies	Refund backlogs; inconsistent service recovery
MRO	Predictive maintenance, parts planning	Sensor data, maintenance logs	Unplanned removals, parts downtime
Cargo	Capacity sell, ops	AWB, load plans	Manual documentation & exception handling

Section 4: AI and technology investment landscape

Air India has disclosed a broad modernization program where technology is a “key differentiator,” including significant investment in new systems and the intent to leap from “catching up” to “taking a leadership position” using cutting-edge technologies—including GenAI. ⁶¹

Key publicly disclosed technology/AI initiatives include:

Salesforce customer service stack transformation to unify customer data and provide AI-assisted tools across touchpoints. ⁵⁸

Adoption of **Salesforce Agentforce** (agentic AI) to automate customer service processes—initially refund issue resolution—while already using **Service Cloud, Sales Cloud, Data Cloud, and Einstein AI**. ⁶²

Microsoft Azure cloud migration: Microsoft’s customer story attributes improved performance and CX using analytics/AI platforms and cites ~20% cost savings via Azure optimization (treat as vendor-reported; validate scope). ⁶³

Establishment of **Air India CODi** with a mandate for customer-facing digital technology and “data and AI capabilities,” signaling an internal build engine for AI-enabled product and operational capabilities. ⁶⁴

Section 5: Broader strategic challenges

- 1) **Fleet modernization execution risk:** Air India's scale of orders (570 aircraft) reflects ambition but also introduces delivery, training, and product standardization challenges during transition. ⁵⁷
- 2) **Customer experience recovery from a weak baseline:** External reporting describes persistent criticism of service and ageing aircraft; transforming this perception demands measurable reliability and service recovery improvements. ⁶⁵
- 3) **Integration complexity across airline entities:** Tata Sons reporting notes consolidation moves (Vistara and AIX Connect integration into Air India / Air India Express), which typically creates short-term complexity in systems, processes, and culture. ⁶⁶
- 4) **Profitability pressure:** Tata Sons' FY25 annual report table shows Air India turnover and a net loss position, implying transformation must deliver both cost efficiency and revenue uplift. ⁵⁶
- 5) **Safety and reputational risk (industry structural):** Aviation shocks can materially affect demand, regulation, and brand trust; recent large-incident reporting around Air India underscores how safety/reputation events can rapidly reshape stakeholder scrutiny. ⁶⁷

Section 6: AI opportunity mapping

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis	Feasibility	Barriers	Impact vs effort
Agentic AI for refunds & disruptions (scale beyond initial use)	Customer service	Agentic AI + workflow automation	Directly attacks high-friction service failures; Air India already live with Agentforce for refund automation. ⁶²	High	Policy complexity; safe automation thresholds	High / Medium
IRROPS decision intelligence	Ops control	Optimization + RL + predictive	Reduce knock-on delays, cost of re-accommodation	Medium	Data integration; operational adoption	High / High
Predictive maintenance + parts demand	MRO	Predictive analytics	Reduce AOG events and improve reliability (critical to brand rebuild)	Medium	Sensor coverage; MRO data quality	High / High
GenAI "policy concierge" for staff	Airport + contact center	GenAI RAG	Faster correct answers, consistent service recovery scripts	High	Content governance; hallucinations	Medium-High / Low-Medium

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis	Feasibility	Barriers	Impact vs effort
Dynamic personalization & retailing	Revenue management	Predictive + GenAI content	Higher conversion and ancillaries; airline peers are pursuing AI-driven concierge and personalization.	Medium	Regulatory/price fairness concerns; test design	Medium-High / Medium

Section 7: Peer and competitor AI benchmarking

Airline peers demonstrate “AI leadership” via cloud-scale data foundations plus customer-facing AI assistants. Delta, for example, has publicly described an AI-powered “Delta Concierge” for personalized journey support, reflecting how airlines are making AI a differentiating layer over the core travel product.

Industry reporting also notes other airlines deploying virtual assistants (e.g., Qatar Airways) and testing GenAI chat assistants (e.g., American), indicating a fast-moving peer benchmark for Air India’s CX ambitions.

Section 8: Workshop-ready insight summary

Company narrative: Air India is executing a multi-year “return to global relevance” transformation (Vihaan.AI) anchored in fleet renewal, operational reliability, and a modern digital stack—while still operating at a loss and integrating merged airline entities.

Top value chain pain points best for AI: refunds/disruption servicing, reliability (MRO + ops), and operational re-planning during disruption.

Top AI opportunities: scale agentic AI for service; IRROPS optimization; predictive maintenance.

Key workshop questions:

What is Air India’s “single source of truth” for customer, flight ops, and maintenance—and what data products are CODi prioritizing?

Which CX failure modes dominate complaints (refund cycle time, misconnects, baggage), and what are current baselines?

Where is the highest ROI: customer service automation, ops optimization, or revenue management—given the current loss profile?

Bold AI bet: A “Disruption Command Center AI” that fuses flight ops, crew legality, maintenance constraints, and customer priorities into a real-time re-optimization engine—minimizing total customer harm and cost during disruptions while automatically triggering refund/rebooking workflows through agentic AI.

ALDI

Section 1: Company snapshot

ALDI is not a single consolidated public company: it is a shared brand operated primarily through **two German family-owned groups, ALDI Nord and ALDI Süd**, with separate governance and reporting norms; this structurally limits consolidated public financial and AI KPI disclosure. ⁷⁶

Global revenue scale is therefore best treated as **estimated**. A third-party retail consulting source reports **combined global sales of €112bn in 2023** for ALDI South + ALDI North (excluding Trader Joe's), but this should be validated in workshop as it is not a unified audited statement. ⁷⁷

Country-level transparency can be higher. In the UK, trade reporting citing Kantar Worldpanel data states Aldi's **sales rose to £18.1bn** in the 12 months to Dec 2024 with **market share 10.8%** (and notes profit pressures tied to pricing and investment). ⁷⁸

Leadership:

ALDI Nord: multiple sources report leadership change—Nicolás de Lope becomes CEO from Jan 1, 2026, succeeding Torsten Hufnagel. ⁷⁹

ALDI Süd Holding: the publicly accessible careers “executive management team” list includes senior officers across People & Strategy, Finance Controlling, Customer Interaction, Global Business Services, and International Supply Chain Management, but **does not expose a single “CEO” field in its accessible text**—treat CEO identification as a validation item. ⁸⁰

Strategic focus (inferred from disclosures and partnerships): maintain **cost leadership**, increase operational stability/efficiency across operating countries, and modernize core platforms and business services using AI-enabled operations and enterprise systems modernization. ⁸¹

Section 2: Customer profile and stakeholder landscape

ALDI's core customer segment is value-seeking grocery shoppers prioritizing **low prices and acceptable quality**, with expectations increasingly shaped by digital convenience, availability, and simplified shopping missions (limited assortment). Inflation sensitivity and private-label trust are critical to loyalty. (General retail inference; validate with ALDI internal CX data.)

Customer satisfaction/NPS: third-party “open web” benchmarks (methodologies vary) report Aldi UK NPS values; one such source reports **Aldi UK NPS of 40**. Treat this as **indicative only** and validate using ALDI's internal Voice-of-Customer system. ⁸²

Stakeholders influencing AI feasibility include suppliers (private label ecosystem), logistics providers, store operations workforce, regulators on pricing, labor, and data privacy (especially for apps/loyalty data).

Section 3: Value chain analysis

Value chain stage	Activities	Data assets generated/ consumed	Typical inefficiencies / pain points
Category management & buying	Assortment decisions, private label specs	Sales, margins, vendor performance	Slow feedback loops; private label iteration cycles
Supplier management	Negotiation, compliance, quality	Contracts, audits, quality records	Manual exceptions; limited visibility into upstream disruptions
Supply chain & logistics	DC operations, transport planning	Forecasts, WMS/ TMS data	Forecast error → stockouts/ overstock; high cost of variability
Store operations	Replenishment, labor scheduling	POS, inventory counts	Labor intensity; out-of-stocks; shrink
Pricing	EDLP execution	Market pricing, elasticity	Protecting price image while managing cost inflation
Inventory replenishment	Automated ordering, reallocation	Demand signals, lead times	Bullwhip; supplier constraints
Private label development	formulation, packaging, QA	R&D, consumer feedback	Time-to-market; compliance documentation

Section 4: AI and technology investment landscape

ALDI's public AI/tech signals are strongest through major partner announcements:

- **TCS and ALDI SOUTH:** TCS states it will act as a strategic IT partner, deploying an **AI-enabled Cloud Operations Solution** to improve operational stability and efficiency across ALDI's operating countries. ⁸³
- **Genpact and ALDI SÜD:** PRNewswire release describes a multi-year partnership to reimagine ALDI's business services leveraging **data, technology, and AI solutions**, with explicit linkage to agility and cost leadership. ⁸⁴
- **Retail tech modernization:** reporting describes ALDI Süd piloting a new predominantly **SAP-based technology landscape** under a program called "Ahead" (as reported by a retail technology outlet), suggesting a foundational ERP/process modernization that is often prerequisite for scaled AI in supply chain and finance. ⁸⁵

Responsible AI: no consolidated ALDI brand-level responsible AI policy is captured here; treat as a governance data gap to confirm (especially if deploying GenAI into customer journeys).

Section 5: Broader strategic challenges

- 1) **Sustaining cost leadership amid inflation and wage/logistics pressures:** UK reporting notes profit pressures linked to lower pricing, infrastructure development and higher staff pay—suggesting margin squeeze is a real constraint in at least some markets. ⁷⁸
- 2) **Technology modernization at global scale:** the presence of AI-enabled cloud operations and SAP

modernization programs suggests significant tech debt and complexity to unwind across countries. ⁸⁶

3) **Supply chain resilience and availability:** discount retail success depends on high availability with low operational complexity; forecasting and replenishment are structurally critical. (Validate with in-house KPIs: OSA, waste, fill rates.)

4) **Leadership and governance fragmentation:** ALDI Nord and ALDI Süd have different leadership and potentially different transformation speeds; Aldi Nord CEO transition in 2026 suggests additional change-management load. ⁸⁷

Section 6: AI opportunity mapping

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis	Feasibility	Barriers	Impact vs effort
Demand forecasting + auto-replenishment upgrades	Replenishment + logistics	Predictive ML	Reduce stockouts/waste; core to low-cost model	Medium-High	Data quality at SKU-store-day; lead time variance	High / Medium
Computer vision for shelf availability and planogram compliance	Store ops	CV + edge AI	Raise on-shelf availability without adding labor	Medium	Hardware rollout; store change mgmt	High / High
GenAI supplier/document copilot	Supplier mgmt	GenAI RAG	Faster compliance checks, QA documentation	Medium	Document heterogeneity; governance	Medium / Medium
Workforce scheduling optimization	Store ops	Optimization + forecasting	Reduce overtime, improve service at peak	Medium	Labor rules; adoption	Medium-High / Medium
AI-enabled cloud ops & AIOps at scale	IT ops	AIOps + automation	Directly aligned to TCS “AI-enabled Cloud Operations” goal of stability/efficiency	High	Toolchain standardization	Medium-High / Medium ⁸³

Section 7: Peer and competitor AI benchmarking

ALDI’s closest competitor archetype is **Lidl** (Schwarz Group). Recent reporting notes Deutsche Telekom and Schwarz Group (Lidl/Kaufland) exploring building an “AI Factory” data center and major investments in data

center infrastructure, illustrating that discounter competitors are investing materially in AI-adjacent infrastructure and digital capability. ⁸⁸

Section 8: Workshop-ready insight summary

Company narrative: ALDI's competitive advantage is operational simplicity and cost leadership. Public signals suggest ALDI is modernizing core platforms and operations with partners (AI-enabled cloud operations, SAP modernization, AI-enabled business services) to protect this advantage under inflation, labor, and complexity pressures. ⁸⁹

Top AI-amenable pain points: availability (forecasting/replenishment), store labor intensity, and supplier/compliance documentation. ⁹⁰

Top AI opportunities: forecasting/replenishment upgrades; store CV for shelf availability; AIOps for stable, efficient global operations. ⁸⁶

Key workshop questions:

What is ALDI's current global data foundation (SKU/store master data quality, event streams), and where are the biggest gaps?

What is the minimum "standard core" platform footprint needed for global AI scaling (ERP, WMS/TMS, cloud ops)? ⁹¹

How will benefits be measured—OSA, waste, DC productivity, store labor minutes, and IT stability KPIs? ⁹²

Bold AI bet: A "Zero-Stockout Store" program combining demand sensing, supplier lead-time prediction, and edge CV shelf monitoring—using AI to keep availability high while preserving ALDI's low-labor operating model. (Feasibility hinges on platform modernization already signaled in partner programs.) ⁹¹

ABB

Section 1: Company snapshot

ABB is a global industrial technology leader in electrification and automation, publishing a detailed annual reporting suite. For FY2024, ABB reported **record revenues of \$32.9bn, operational EBITA margin of 18.1%, and free cash flow of \$3.9bn.** ⁹³

ABB's FY2024 business areas and revenue contribution are explicitly disclosed as: **Electrification (\$15.448bn), Motion (\$7.787bn), Process Automation (\$6.756bn), and Robotics & Discrete Automation (\$3.213bn).** ⁹⁴

Geographic footprint: ABB states it operates in approximately **100 countries** and is headquartered in Zurich, Switzerland. ⁹⁵

Leadership: ABB appointed **Morten Wierod** as CEO effective **Aug 1, 2024.** ⁹⁶

CFO leadership changed again: reporting indicates ABB appointed **Christian Nilsson** as CFO effective **Feb 1, 2026** (an important near-term governance and execution factor). ⁹⁷

Digital/AI leadership: Rajesh Ramachandran is described publicly as **Global Chief Digital Officer for ABB Process Automation**, leading digital business initiatives and industrial AI transformation. ⁹⁸

Strategic priorities include profitable growth and performance; ABB provides forward-looking expectations in its results communications (e.g., mid-single digit comparable revenue growth outlook and operational EBITA margin improvement expectations for full-year 2025). ⁹⁹

Major portfolio transformation: ABB announced (and SoftBank confirmed) an agreement for SoftBank to acquire ABB's **Robotics division** for **\$5.375bn enterprise value**, framing the combination as creating customer value by merging ABB Robotics technology with SoftBank's AI/robotics capabilities; closing is expected mid-to-late 2026 subject to approvals. ¹⁰⁰

Section 2: Customer profile and stakeholder landscape

ABB serves industrial and infrastructure customers requiring electrification, automation, and digital solutions; within FY2024 commentary ABB highlights strong Electrification demand in **data centers and utilities**, indicating these are high-importance customer segments. ¹⁰¹

ABB's stakeholder ecosystem includes regulators (safety, energy, industrial compliance), critical suppliers, and strategic technology partners (notably hyperscalers for industrial AI), plus investors who will closely scrutinize the Robotics divestment and ABB's post-divestment strategic focus. ¹⁰²

Section 3: Value chain analysis

Value chain stage	Activities	Data assets generated/ consumed	Typical inefficiencies / pain points
R&D and engineering	Product development, software/firmware	Requirements, CAD/ PLM, code	Engineering cycle time; knowledge reuse
Procurement	Sourcing, supplier risk	Supplier performance, BOM	Volatility and shortages; cost swings
Production & quality	Manufacturing, testing	OT data, SPC, quality records	Yield losses; manual inspection
Supply chain	Logistics, inventory	Forecasts, shipment status	Late components → delayed deliveries
Customer/project delivery	Systems integration, commissioning	Project docs, config data	Documentation burden; integration risk
Field service	Maintenance, support	Service logs, faults	Dispatch inefficiency; knowledge access
Energy management & optimization	Control, monitoring	Sensor data, energy consumption	Optimization complexity, customer ROI proof

Section 4: AI and technology investment landscape

ABB's AI narrative is strongly linked to industrial AI and digital platforms:

- ABB and Microsoft have publicly discussed strengthening their partnership to boost ABB's **industrial generative AI suite**, signaling hyperscaler alignment for industrial GenAI delivery. ¹⁰³
- ABB's digital leadership is actively positioned around industrial AI transformation (via the Process Automation CDO role). ⁹⁸
- ABB also references recognition in industrial IoT platforms (Gartner Magic Quadrant leadership claim via ABB's own newsroom), which ABB frames as evidence of capability in data-driven industrial outcomes. ¹⁰⁴

Section 5: Broader strategic challenges

- 1) **Portfolio transition risk (Robotics divestment):** the divestment reshapes ABB's identity and financial profile; execution risk includes separation complexity, customer continuity, and ensuring ABB's remaining businesses capture strategic upside. ¹⁰⁰
- 2) **Maintaining high margins while growing:** ABB's strong profitability (18.1% operational EBITA margin) becomes a benchmark that future AI/digital investments must sustain or improve. ¹⁰⁵
- 3) **CFO transition and governance continuity:** CFO change effective Feb 2026 adds near-term execution considerations for capital allocation and reporting. ⁹⁷
- 4) **Industrial talent and productivity constraints:** ABB frames AI as industrial transformation; competitors are positioning GenAI copilots to address labor shortages and productivity (see benchmarking). ¹⁰⁶

Section 6: AI opportunity mapping

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis	Feasibility	Barriers	Impact vs effort
Engineering copilot for product & systems design	R&D/ engineering	GenAI + code assistants + RAG over PLM	Reduce engineering cycle time, improve reuse	Medium	IP governance; PLM integration	High / High
Predictive quality & anomaly detection in production	Production	ML + CV + time series	Reduce scrap/ rework; improve yield	High	OT data readiness; scaling across plants	Medium-High / Medium
Field service GenAI assistant	Field service	GenAI RAG	Faster diagnosis and first-time fix, improved customer uptime	High	Knowledge base hygiene; safety	High / Medium

AI opportunity	Value chain location	Technique	Value hypothesis	Feasibility	Barriers	Impact vs effort
Energy optimization AI for customers	Energy mgmt	Optimization + predictive	Increase customer ROI, support electrification narrative	Medium	Customer data access; proof of value	Medium-High / High
Industrial AI platform expansion	Cross value chain	Industrial AI platforms	Strengthen differentiation in process automation	Medium	Competitive parity; ecosystem integration	High / High ¹⁰⁷

Section 7: Peer and competitor AI benchmarking

Industrial automation peers are rapidly productizing GenAI copilots. Siemens publicly positions its **Industrial Copilot** as a GenAI capability to empower people in industry. ¹⁰⁸

Schneider Electric has publicly described an **industrial copilot developed with Microsoft**, integrating Azure AI Foundry with industrial automation, explicitly targeting productivity and workforce constraints. ¹⁰⁹

ABB's benchmark posture should therefore be evaluated against (a) competitor copilot maturity, and (b) ABB's ability to embed AI into installed base service and project delivery—especially after Robotics divestment changes the portfolio. ¹¹⁰

Section 8: Workshop-ready insight summary

Company narrative: ABB is a high-performing electrification and automation leader, entering a significant portfolio transition through the Robotics divestment to SoftBank while simultaneously deepening industrial GenAI capabilities via hyperscaler partnerships and internal digital leadership. ¹¹¹

Top AI-amenable pain points: engineering cycle time/documentation load, production quality variability, and field service knowledge friction. ¹¹²

Top AI opportunities: field service GenAI assistant; predictive quality/CV; engineering copilots. ¹¹³

Key workshop questions:

Post-robotics divestment, what are ABB's priority "AI growth wedges" (data centers, utilities, process industries)? ¹¹⁴

What is ABB's reference architecture for industrial GenAI (data ingestion, model hosting, cybersecurity, auditability) with Microsoft? ¹⁰³

How will ABB measure AI value—margin expansion, service attach, delivery cycle time, avoided downtime? ¹⁰⁵

Bold AI bet: A "**Commissioning-to-Uptime Autonomous Layer**": GenAI + predictive models that generate commissioning plans, validate configurations against real OT signals, and continuously optimize performance post-go-live—turning ABB's installed base into a compounding data advantage. (Requires robust industrial AI platform execution.) ¹¹⁵

Cross-company workshop prompts for facilitators

Across these five organizations, the most productive workshop pattern is to force alignment between **strategy KPIs** and **value-chain AI bets**:

- “Which 3–5 KPIs *must* move in the next 12–18 months?” (ABN: cost/income & ROE; Vodafone: customer experience and simplification; Air India: CX + reliability; ABB: margin + portfolio focus; ALDI: cost leadership and availability). ¹¹⁶
- “Where is work most manual and most expensive today—and why hasn’t it been automated already?” (Probe governance constraints: model risk in banking; safety in aviation/industrial; privacy in telecom; procurement/legacy ERP in retail.) ¹¹⁷
- “What is the minimum data product set needed for scale?” (Customer 360 + interaction logs; asset telemetry; supplier lead times; compliant knowledge base.) ¹¹⁸
- “What operating model will scale AI safely?” (Vodafone’s AI Governance Board + guardrails is a useful reference for governance structure; other firms should define equivalents.) ³⁶

These prompts help transform the workshop from “use case brainstorming” into an execution-ready portfolio: **a small set of AI programs with clear owners, baselines, governance, and measurable KPI movement.**

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